Language Usage practice booklet: Grade 2 expectations

Grade 2 · Practice booklet

Name: _____

What this booklet is

This is general practice written for Language Usage at Grade 2 level, following the Common Core State Standards for English Language Arts standards for that grade. It is not made from your child's MAP questions, and it does not replace the classroom. Use it as a guide to what a child is expected to know and do at this level.

How to use it

- Do one section at a time, about 10 minutes, 3 days a week. Stop while it is still enjoyable.
- Read each question all the way through, twice, before answering. Underline the key words and say what is being asked.
- Take your time. A careful, correct answer is worth more than a fast one.
- Use scrap paper and show the working. Then check the answer before moving on.
- Ask your child to explain how they got an answer, even when it is right.
- If a section feels too hard, do the section before it again, or ask the teacher. That is part of learning, not a problem.

Section 1: Capital letters, punctuation and spelling

Standards practised: L.2.2, L.2.2a, L.2.2b, L.2.2c, L.2.2d, L.2.2e

A worked example

Correct this sentence: on saturday salem went to dubai

1. Start the sentence with a capital letter: On.
2. Days of the week, names of people and names of places start with a capital: Saturday, Salem, Dubai.
3. A sentence that tells something ends with a full stop.

On Saturday Salem went to Dubai.

Questions

1. Rewrite with correct capital letters: on friday hamdan went to abu dhabi.

2. Rewrite with correct capital letters: we visit our cousins during ramadan.

3. Add the missing comma to the greeting of a letter: Dear Layla

4. Add the missing comma to the closing of a letter: Your friend

5. Write each pair of words as one word with an apostrophe: is not, we are, I am.

6. Add the missing apostrophe: A falcons feather was soft.

7. Which is written correctly? A) Salems bag B) Salem's bag C) Salems' bag

8. Which word is spelled correctly? A) frend B) friend C) freind

9. Which word is spelled correctly? A) sed B) sayd C) said

10. Add the correct end mark: Can we go to the beach

11. Which word comes first in a dictionary: date or camel?

12. Explain why Dubai starts with a capital letter but city does not.

Section 2: Grammar and word usage

Standards practised: L.2.1, L.2.1a, L.2.1b, L.2.1c, L.2.1d, L.2.1e, L.2.1f, L.2.3a, L.2.4, L.2.4a, L.2.4b, L.2.4c, L.2.5, L.2.5b, L.2.6

A worked example

Choose the right word: Yesterday Maryam (goed / went) to the souq.

1. Yesterday tells us the action already happened, so we need a past tense verb.
2. Go is an irregular verb: it does not add ed.
3. The past tense of go is went.

went (Yesterday Maryam went to the souq.)

Questions

1. Choose the right word: A (flock / tower) of birds flew over the creek.

2. Write the plural of each noun: tooth, child, goose.

3. Choose the right word: Maryam made the card all by (her / herself).

4. Choose the right word: Yesterday Khalid (eated / ate) a date.

5. Fix the verb: Yesterday the birds flyed over the creek.

6. Find the adjective in this sentence: The sleepy camel rested in the shade.

7. Find the adverb in this sentence: The oryx ran quickly across the sand.

8. Choose the right word: Noura wrote her name (careful / carefully).

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9. Join the two sentences into one sentence with the word but: Hamdan wanted to play outside. It was too hot.

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10. Choose the best joining word: It was raining, (so / but) we stayed inside.

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11. Which is better to say to a teacher? A) Hey, gimme that book. B) May I please borrow that book?

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12. Write one sentence about a camel that uses an adjective and an adverb.

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13. Read: Layla felt nervous before she spoke, but her friends smiled and she soon felt calm. What does the word nervous mean? A) a little afraid B) very hungry C) full of joy

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14. The prefix un means not. What does each word mean? unhappy, unlock. Then name the root word (the word left when the prefix is taken away) in unfair.

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15. Put these words in order from the quietest to the loudest: shout, whisper, talk. Then say which word is the loudest.

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16. Your teacher read you a story about an enormous whale shark, and enormous means very, very big. Say or write a sentence about a camel, a mountain or a tower that uses the new word enormous.

Section 3: Writing

Standards practised: W.2.1, W.2.2, W.2.3, W.2.5, W.2.6, W.2.7, W.2.8, SL.2.1, SL.2.2, SL.2.3, SL.2.4, SL.2.5, SL.2.6

A worked example

Put these sentences in the best order to make a short story: (A) At last he waved to the fishermen. (B) Then a wooden dhow sailed into view. (C) Khalid went to the creek at sunrise.

1. A story needs a beginning, a middle and an end.
2. The beginning tells who and where: C, Khalid went to the creek.
3. The middle tells what happens next (look for the word Then): B.
4. The end finishes the story (look for At last): A.

C, B, A

Questions

1. Write a sentence that gives your opinion: Is it better to read a book or to play outside?

   _____

2. Finish this opinion with a reason: I like going to the beach because ...

   _____

3. Write a last sentence for this opinion piece: I think everyone should visit the Hajar mountains. The views are beautiful. The air is cool.

   _____

4. Write two facts about the Arabian oryx.

   _____

5. Put these steps in order: (A) Water the soil. (B) Dig a small hole. (C) Cover the seed with soil. (D) Put the seed in the hole.

   _____

6. Put these sentences in order to make a story: (A) She found her mother by the dates stall. (B) Hind got lost in the souq. (C) Hind hugged her mother and felt happy.

7. Choose the best word to start this piece: ____ Maryam ate her breakfast. Then she went to school. A) First B) Last C) Finally

8. Add more detail to this sentence: The falcon flew.

9. Write a sentence that tells how Salem felt when he lost his hat in the wind.

10. Which sentence does not belong, and why? Hind went to the souq. She bought some saffron. I like football. The saffron smelled sweet.

11. Name two things to check when you read over your own writing.

12. Talking together, parent and child take turns. Parent: say clearly, Yesterday I saw a falcon at the park with my friend. Then say to your child: Ask me one question about what I said. Answer it. Then say: Now tell me something about falcons or parks.

13. The parent reads aloud this short story, twice if needed: Hamdan and his sister Noura planted a small date palm in their garden. Every day they gave it water. After a month a green leaf grew. They were proud. The child retells the story in their own words.

14. Parent: show your child a picture or photo of a camel in the desert, or let them draw one first. Say: (1) Tell me about your picture in three complete sentences, speaking clearly. (2) Now tell me one more thing we could add to the picture to show more detail.

15. Parent and child read a book or page about camels together. Parent: say (1) Tell me two facts you learned, in your own words. (2) Now say the first sentence you would write to start a short report about camels.

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16. Optional, done with an adult beside you: if you have a tablet or computer, the adult helps you type three sentences about something you learned this week (or write them on paper if you prefer). Then read them aloud and say two things you learned.

Answer guide for parents

Section 1: Capital letters, punctuation and spelling

1. On Friday Hamdan went to Abu Dhabi. (A sentence starts with a capital, and so do days, names of people and names of places.)
2. We visit our cousins during Ramadan. (Names of holidays and special months start with a capital.)
3. Dear Layla, (A comma goes after the name in a greeting.)
4. Your friend, (A comma goes after the closing words, and the name is written on the next line.)
5. isn't, we're, I'm
6. A falcon's feather was soft. (The feather belongs to one falcon, so we add 's.)
7. B, Salem's bag. (The bag belongs to Salem.)
8. B, friend.
9. C, said.
10. Can we go to the beach? (A sentence that asks something ends with a question mark.)
11. camel (c comes before d in the alphabet).
12. Dubai is the special name of one place, so it needs a capital letter. City is a word for any city, so it does not.

Section 2: Grammar and word usage

1. flock (a flock is a group of birds).
2. teeth, children, geese
3. herself (the girl did it on her own).
4. ate (eat is an irregular verb).
5. Yesterday the birds flew over the creek. (The past tense of fly is flew.)
6. sleepy (it tells what the camel is like).
7. quickly (it tells how the oryx ran).
8. carefully (it tells how she wrote, so we need the adverb).
9. Hamdan wanted to play outside, but it was too hot. (But joins two ideas that go against each other.)
10. so (staying inside is the result of the rain).
11. B (careful, polite language is used with a teacher).
12. A good answer is a full sentence with a describing word for the camel and a word that tells how it moves or acts. Model: The tall camel walked gently across the desert.
13. A, a little afraid. (The word but and the later word calm are clues that nervous is the opposite of calm.)
14. unhappy means not happy; unlock means to open something that was locked (undo the lock). The root word in unfair is fair.
15. whisper, talk, shout. Shout is the loudest. (Closely related words can have a weaker or stronger meaning.)
16. A good answer is a full sentence that uses enormous correctly for something very big. Model: The Hajar mountains are enormous.

Section 3: Writing

1. A good answer states one clear opinion in a full sentence. Model: I think it is better to play outside.
2. A good answer gives a reason that makes sense. Model: I like going to the beach because I can build sandcastles.
3. A good answer ends the piece and repeats the opinion. Model: That is why I think everyone should visit the Hajar mountains.
4. A good answer gives two true facts in full sentences. Model: The Arabian oryx has long straight horns. It lives in the desert.
5. B, D, C, A
6. B, A, C (the problem comes first, then the search, then the ending).
7. A, First. (The word Then follows, so this is the first step.)
8. A good answer adds describing words, or tells where, when or how. Model: The brown falcon flew high over the desert at sunrise.
9. A good answer says how Salem felt and may tell why. Model: Salem felt sad when the wind blew his hat away.
10. I like football. It is not about Hind at the souq, so it should be taken out.
11. Any two of: a capital letter at the start of each sentence and for names, an end mark, spelling, and that every sentence makes sense.
12. A good answer: the child waits until the parent has finished, then asks a question about the falcon that fits, such as Where was the falcon? or What colour was it? The child then listens to the reply and adds a related comment, taking turns without interrupting.
13. A good retell tells who (Hamdan and Noura), what they did (planted a date palm and watered it), what happened (a green leaf grew) and how they felt (proud), in an order that makes sense and in complete sentences.
14. A good answer is three full sentences with details such as colour, size, the sand, the sky or what the camel is doing, spoken clearly and not too fast, with an idea like adding a palm tree or the sun to the drawing.
15. A good answer gives two true facts taken from the book, such as camels store fat in their humps or camels can go a long time without water, said in the child's own words, and a first sentence that names the topic, such as Camels are amazing desert animals.
16. A good answer shows three sentences (typed or written) read aloud. The child names two things they learned and where the information came from, such as a book, a trip or a talk. The adult helps with typing and saving, but the ideas are the child's.